

[Return to Search](#)

Tribal studies in northern Nigeria

Author(S): Meek, C. K. (Charles Kingsley)**Document Type:** Book Chapter**Original Page:** 32**Culture (OWC):** [Katab \(FF38\)](#)**Region:** Africa**Sub Region:** Western Africa**Field Date:** 1925-1930**Coverage Date:** 1925-1930**Place Coverage:** Zangon Kataf District, Kaduna, Nigeria**Section Title(S)**KIBORI VILLAGE AREA.—KINDRED—AMURUM ALAN—SUB-CLAN ASWEN-CLAN

A Katab appears to be, to some extent, on playmate terms with all his cousins,¹ but he will never play with a female cousin whose potential guardian he is, that is to say, whom he will one day give in marriage. This is noteworthy as showing that [33](#) the playmate relationship is sometimes dependent on a potential social relationship. The playmate relationship may exist between a man and his wife's brother's wife, but only if she belongs to some clan other than his own; for a woman of the same clan is a sister, and the joking relationship with a sister is not permissible.

[602](#)
[Kin Relationships](#)[605](#)
[Cousins](#)[607](#)
[Siblings-In-Law](#)

¹But ortho-cousins are only playmates in a modified sense.

Human Relations Area Files

755 Prospect Street

New Haven, CT 06511

General Inquiries:  hraf@yale.eduIssues and Bugs:  hraf-support@yale.edu[Terms and Conditions](#) · [Accessibility](#) · [Cookie Policy](#)